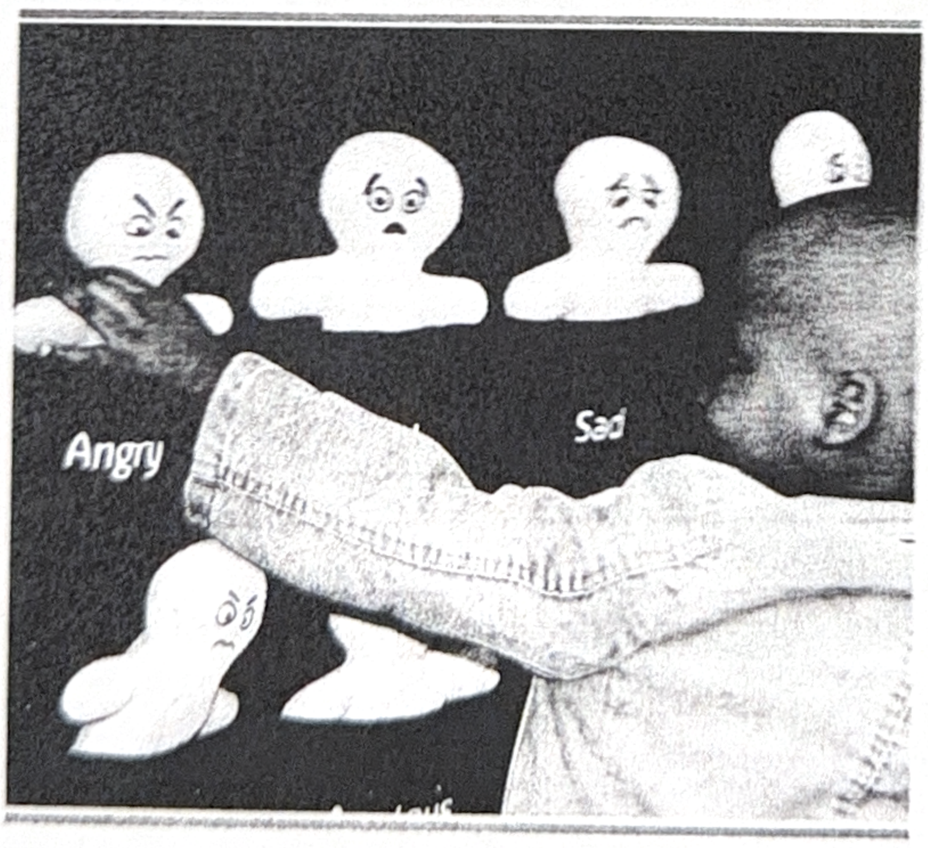
Happy and calm hold the overall message that many of us strive to achieve: Life is good. Yet, happy and calm are not something you achieve or work at, they are the state we relax into when we stop resisting "what is." Happy and calm is our natural state. Babies and young children live in a natural state of happy and calm, of joy! The message of happy and calm is to remember to be grateful, to remember love is the answer regardless of the problem and to remember we are all connected.

This final step, I Solve, will lead us back to our original trigger with new insight and skills. In my story with my mom and dad, I was empowered to approach my trigger, "Dad is going to kill Mom," with a new perspective of their impressive and hard-fought love story. As we repeat this five-step process over and over again, we heal ourselves, improve our relationships and make choices that move us closer to achieving our goals.

At this point, you might be ready to make a change in your life. I've cited research, discussed strategies and explored enough examples to sufficiently pave the way. The five steps of self-regulation do not come automatically; we must practice them ourselves, consciously and with vigilance. The more we are willing to change ourselves and improve our self-regulation skills, the better we can coach and interact with our children and with each other. What we offer to others we strengthen in ourselves. See the best and you become your best, guaranteed!



Now it's time to apply all we've learned toward helping children. As parents and educators, we tend to want to leave the world a bit better than it was when we arrived. We want each generation to be a bit wiser, happier and more fullfilled than ours. The next chapter contains information that is vital to helping us manifest this passion.



Commitment: I am willing to practice the five-step self-regulation process with myself. I now realize that asking a child to do something I am not willing to do myself sets us both up for failure.

Signed: _____ Date: _____